

Aju Ani Justus

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Education

University of Birmingham , PhD in Computer Science	2024 – Present
• Research focus: Heterogenous-Agent Reinforcement Learning, Agent Communication, Human-Agent Teaming	
University of Birmingham , MSc in Computer Science	2022 – 2023
• Postgraduate Professional Development Award	
• Dissertation: <i>Music Generation using Human-In-The-Loop Reinforcement Learning</i>	
College of Engineering Trivandrum , B.Tech in Civil Engineering	2015 – 2019

Publications

Music Generation using Human-In-The-Loop Reinforcement Learning	2023
<i>Aju Ani Justus</i> https://doi.org/10.3233/FAIA251250 Proceedings of the 2023 IEEE International Conference on Big Data (BigData)	
LLMs as Policy-Agnostic Teammates: A Case Study in Human Proxy Design for Heterogeneous Agent Teams	2025
<i>Aju Ani Justus</i> , Chris Baber https://doi.org/10.3233/FAIA251250 Proceedings of the 28th European Conference on Artificial Intelligence (ECAI 2025)	
Grounded Communication Policies in Heterogeneous Agent Reinforcement Learning	2026
<i>Aju Ani Justus</i> 25th International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multiagent Systems (AAMAS 2026), Doctoral Consortium [Awarded scholarship from AAMAS to attend and present at AAMAS annual conference]	
voice2mode: Phonation Mode Classification in Singing using Self-Supervised Speech Models	2026
<i>Aju Ani Justus</i> , Ruchit Agrawal, Sudarsana Reddy Kadiri, Shrikanth Narayanan IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP 2026) [Collaboration outside PhD, personal project]	
Learning to Team through Human Proxies in Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning	Under review for 2026
<i>Aju Ani Justus</i> , Chris Baber, Andrew Howes, Daniel Cassenti, Aditya Acharya	
GridHunt: A Customizable Heterogeneous Predator-Prey Suite for Mixed-Motive MARL and Human-Agent Teaming	Under review for 2026
<i>Aju Ani Justus</i> , Chris Baber, Aditya Acharya, Daniel Cassenti	

Experience

Teaching Assistant , University of Birmingham	2023 – Present
• Software Workshop 1 & 2 (Python), Object-Oriented Programming (Java), Mathematical and Logical Foundations of Computer Science, ALGO Club (Python), Building Useable Software.	
Machine Learning Engineer , Accenture Applied Intelligence	2019 – 2022
• Developed and deployed ML solutions for global CPG clients, driving significant gains in forecasting accuracy, supply chain efficiency, and operational decision-making.	
• Led collaboration with cross-functional teams including data scientists, engineers, and business stakeholders to deliver cloud-native demand planning solutions cloud-based data platforms.	
• Mentored junior engineers and led training sessions on best practices in supervised learning.	